

SPONSOR CHALLENGES

LONG LAKE

Convince a Non-Believer

AI has taken parts of the world by storm, but many people have yet to see what it can do. Some use it as a glorified spellcheck or a search engine. Some watched an early model miscount the r's in "strawberry" and never came back.

Many are one great experience away from changing their minds.

At Long Lake, we bring frontier AI to people and businesses that cutting-edge technology has often overlooked. Imagine an AI-powered product or experience that a skeptic would try, love, and want to use again. What would you create to give them that moment?

Top 3 Receive Prizes

ASUS

Build What's Next with ASUS

Use ASUS products and/or Zenni Claw to build your projects (Bonus points if both). ASUS hardware will be available for hackers to check out on a first come first serve basis.

Top 3 Receive Prizes

MAXIMOR

Build an Agent for Financial Workflows

Build an agent that learns to automate a real workflow in the Office of the CFO. Your agent should be able to execute a finance workflow, identify when and why it fails, and improve its own behavior over repeated runs.

Examples include:

- Reconciling transactions across multiple systems
- Investigating unexpected changes in financial results

- Resolving invoice or payment exceptions
- Gathering and validating audit support
- Preparing cash or close reports from messy source data
We care less about the specific workflow and more about how intelligently your agent handles it.
Strong submissions should demonstrate:
- Multi-step reasoning and tool use
- Learning from previous runs, corrections, or feedback
- Handling ambiguous or exceptional cases
- Measurable improvement in accuracy, reliability, cost, or speed
- Appropriate human review when the agent is uncertain
A one-shot chatbot, extraction pipeline, or hard-coded accounting workflow is not enough. We want agents that get better at doing real financial work.
Top 3 Receive Prizes
1st place: \$4,000
2nd place: \$2,000
3rd place: \$1,000
Top 5 teams are fast tracked to software engineering intern/new-grad roles.

<u>VOLORIDGE</u>
Signal in the Noise
At Voloridge, data is at the heart of everything we do. Every day we work with enormous, noisy, and often messy datasets, searching for signals that are informative, reliable, and ultimately useful. The hardest part is rarely obtaining data—it's figuring out what matters.
Great engineers build systems that can process data at scale. Great researchers discover patterns hidden inside it. This challenge is about both.
The Challenge
Build something interesting using one or more real-world public datasets.
We'll provide a curated selection of large, publicly available datasets spanning topics such as earth observation, healthcare, transportation, climate, genomics, economics, and more. Your goal

is to extract insight, build a useful tool, discover an unexpected pattern, or create an application that demonstrates thoughtful use of data.

Your project might:

- Discover interesting trends or hidden relationships.
- Clean, organize, or enrich a difficult dataset.
- Build interactive visualizations.
- Create novel search or exploration tools.
- Train machine learning models.
- Combine multiple datasets to generate new insights.
- Build systems capable of processing very large datasets efficiently.
- Create something we haven't even thought of.

Datasets

We've selected a curated collection of public datasets. Teams are welcome to use one dataset or combine several. You can find the datasets here:

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1dUiHEbzi3ljph8geUyZck6tLffQwFkwt/view?usp=sharing>.

What We'll Be Looking For

Projects will be evaluated on several dimensions:

- Originality — Did you do something unexpected or particularly clever?
- Technical Excellence — Did you build something robust, scalable, or technically impressive?
- Insight — Did your project uncover meaningful information or produce useful analysis?
- Execution — Is the project polished, usable, and well demonstrated?

Good luck, and happy hacking!

Prize: (1st Place Only) \$5,000 distributed among the team + fast tracked interview to Ascend or Internship position - provided individually to each team member

ARDUINO

Touch Grass: Build Something That Understands the Real World

The most revolutionary software in the world is useless if it can't feel the world.

Code lives in the abstract. Light, temperature, sound, pressure, motion, humidity, that's reality. Software has conquered the digital world. Now it's time to build systems that understand the physical one. This challenge asks you to build the bridge between them.

Using the Arduino® UNO™ Q, you'll pull raw, messy, beautiful data from the physical environment around you and turn it into something that matters: a tool that helps someone, an experience that

surprises someone, a system that understands the world a little better than it did before.
The best projects won't just visualize sensor data, they'll transform it into meaningful, intelligent experiences.
Top 2 Receive Awards

VISA
Reimagine Shopping: Use Generative AI to Craft Smarter and Effortless Commerce Experiences
Shopping is evolving from searching and browsing to conversing and collaborating with AI. Consumers expect AI-powered experiences that help them discover products, compare options, personalize recommendations, manage budgets, and complete purchases seamlessly. At the same time, merchants need trusted, secure, and intelligent payment experiences that drive conversion and customer satisfaction.
Your challenge is to design and build a commerce experience powered by Generative AI that makes shopping more intuitive, personalized, and frictionless while enabling secure and trusted payments.
Teams should demonstrate how AI can transform one or more stages of the shopping journey:
- Discovery
- Decision-making
- Personalization
- Checkout
- Payments
- Loyalty and rewards
- Post-purchase experiences
Prize: \$5,000 for winning team

COGNITION
Best Use of Devin
Use Devin, the AI software engineer, to build something exciting. Ambitious ideas welcome: Devin plans, writes, tests, and ships the code alongside you, so aim bigger than a weekend normally allows. Projects judged on creativity, novelty, and polish.
Prize: \$5K distributed among all team members of the single winning team

WARP

Best Developer Tool

Build a hack that focuses on improving the developer experience in some meaningful way - this could be tackling any part of the development lifecycle (creating, modifying or testing software)!

Prize presented by Warp (the agentic development environment for the 21st century). You do not need to use Warp in your hack, but we'd love for you to try it to build your project!

Prize: Each member of the winning team will receive Keychron mechanical keyboards.

ESPRESSIF

Best Use of Espressif Hardware & Solutions (In AIoT)

Espressif hardware will be available for hackers to check out, including:

- ESP32-S3-Box

- ESP32-S3-DevKitC-1-N8R8

Prize: one winning team receives 1 × AI Pyramid Computing Box Pro 8GB Version (AX8850) & 4 × S31 Korvo Boards

DIMENSIONAL

Best Use of Dimensional

Build an intelligent system for the physical world using Dimensional's dimOS. Create an agentic robotics application that connects perception, reasoning, and real-world action through reusable modules, skills, and blueprints. Projects may run in simulation or on hardware, and will be judged on originality, technical execution, autonomy, and business impact.

Learn more about Dimensional: <https://demos.dimensionai.org/>

Prize:

1st winner: Unitree Go 2 PER TEAM + interview opportunity for internship or full-time

2nd winner: \$500 cash PER TEAM + interview opportunity for internship or full-time

OPENAI

OpenAI Challenge

Use the OpenAI API to build something ambitious, with Codex as your development teammate. Whether Codex helps you ship a focused feature, turn a prototype into a polished product, or

coordinate an end-to-end build, show us how it helped you go further than you otherwise could.

Projects will be assessed on:

- What you built with the OpenAI API: how creatively and effectively the API powers the experience.

- How Codex helped you build it: how meaningfully it supported planning, implementation, testing, debugging, or iteration.

- During your demo, show the working product, explain how the OpenAI API is used, and share one concrete way Codex improved your process or outcome. First, second, and third place will go to the strongest projects across both areas.

Check out our documentation on Codex [use case examples](#) to get started, and feel free to stop by our booth if you have any questions!

Note: only participants submitting to our challenge will receive credits.

Top 3 Receive Prizes

1st Place: One year of ChatGPT Pro, an OpenAI backpack, and an OpenAI swag bundle

2nd Place: Six months of ChatGPT Pro

3rd Place: Three months of ChatGPT Pro

RUNPOD

Runpod Challenge

To be announced!

ELASTIC

Find the Signal

Best use of Elasticsearch to turn complex, messy data into insights, answers or actions.

Prize:

1st Place: Meta Quest 3S Headphones per team member

2nd Place: Bose QuietComfort Headphones per team member

THE TOKEN COMPANY

LLM cost saving challenge

The Token Company challenge is to optimize and save as much as possible on the LLM stack of your hackathon project. We'll look into awarding the most creative cost saving

solution where you were able to save on the LLM costs your product has (assuming your hackathon project relies on LLMs underneath).

This could range from using cheaper models, cache optimization, smaller inputs, more dense outputs or anything more creative beyond. We are mainly looking for savings inside your product, not the savings you made while coding and making it (although particularly creative solutions accepted here too). Feel free to use our compression models accessible at thetokencompany.com too (we'll unlock sign in on Friday 18th on our website for all).

The most creative team will receive a \$500 cash award from The Token Company and a boosted interview route for full-time and intern positions in San Francisco.

ELEVENLABS

ElevenLabs Challenge

What we look for in the best project built with ElevenLabs:

Agentic Depth: Does the project go beyond simple text-to-speech? We prioritize autonomous agents that handle complex logic and real-time dialogue.

Interaction Design: How lifelike is the experience? We value projects that master low-latency response times and emotional inflection.

Technical Integration: Creative use of the ElevenLabs API - especially multimodal implementations (Voice + Video) or clever prompt engineering for the Agent's personality.

Novelty: A use case we haven't seen before that solves a real-world problem using conversational AI.

META

Bringing People Closer Together with AI

At Meta and Facebook, we believe technology can bring people closer together and deepen real human connections. Build the AI-powered social product you wish existed, or one that helps strengthen connections you care about in new ways.

AI should play a meaningful role in the experience. It might synthesize a group discussion into plans everyone would enjoy, organize scattered family updates into a shared story, or identify common interests that could spark a new connection.

Projects will be judged on how meaningfully they strengthen human connection, how essential and well-integrated AI is, originality, and the strength of the working demo.
What you can use:
You are free to use any technology stack for your hack. Each HackMIT 2026 participants is eligible to redeem \$50 in free Muse API Credits (see terms and conditions and redemption instructions here) We encourage you to try out and explore Meta’s AI tools and APIs to power your hacks:
- Muse Spark: Meta’s text model for chat, reasoning, and agentic experiences
- Muse Image: Meta’s image-generation model.
- Muse Voice Transcribe: Meta’s real-time audio perception model
- Muse: Meta's first personal AI agent, powered by Muse Spark. You can explore writing connectors, exposing your project's data or actions as a tool Muse can call.
- Facebook Graph API: Access public and user-consented data through a developer app.
What to submit:
- A working prototype and a 2- to 3-minute demo video showing the project in action.
- A public code repository.
- A short write-up explaining who the project is for, how it strengthens connection, and why AI is essential.
Official Rules apply.
Top 3 all receive the following prizes:
- Invitation to advance to the Round 2 Hackathon hosted at Meta's Menlo Park campus. Travel and accommodations provided. Advancement to Round 2 is subject to eligibility verification and compliance with Meta's Round 2 Official Rules.
- Meta swag bag

GIVECAMPUS
GiveCampus Challenge
Every school sits on a database full of people who care — alumni, parents, past donors, volunteers, event-goers — and most of that potential never gets touched. Advancement teams are small, their lists are enormous, and the person most likely to give this year is usually buried thousands of rows down.
We'll give you a dataset of school constituents. Build something that helps a fundraising team figure out who to reach out to, and why. A few directions: segment constituents into groups with something real in common (same years on campus, same club, same city, young recurring

donors) and pitch the next move for that group; recommend the single next best action per person (thank-you, event invite, reunion mailer, ask); find the hidden dollars that would let the school raise an extra \$1 million this year, like loyal donors nobody has asked in five years or the alum who just got a big promotion and is still being asked for their 2016 gift amount; or build a natural language copilot that answers "who are the 20 people I need to reach before Giving Day, and why those 20?"
We're looking for judgment about the job, not just accuracy on a metric. A gift officer has 40 hours a week and thousands of people on their list – build the tool that tells them where to spend Tuesday.
GiveCampus is the fundraising platform for education. Since 2015, more than 1,500 schools, colleges, and universities have raised over \$7 billion on our platform in service of one mission: advancing the quality, the affordability, and the accessibility of education.
Prizes:
1st Place (Grand prizes): Private lunch or dinner with GiveCampus engineering/product leaders in DC plus \$500 team donation to education non profit and a feature spotlight on GiveCampus LinkedIn or blog
2nd Place (Most likely to Ship): 60 min Mentorship session with a GiveCampus founder, CTO, or senior engineer on Zoom and Remarkable tablets
Best Beginner / Early Builder Prize: Headphones or Giftcards & 30 minute resume review conversation with GiveCampus Technical Recruiter

RAMP
Save Time. Save Money.
Build anything that saves people time and money.
Prizes:
1st Place: Nintendo Switch, Oura Ring (sized & shipped after event), \$100 per member
2nd Place: Nintendo Switch, Sweatpants, \$100 per member
3rd Place: Ramp Swag - Hoodie, Sweatpant, Owala, Frisbee, \$100 per member

SPACEXAI
Make it Legendary with SpaceXAI
Space gives you more to work with than almost any other field. You have access to enormous public datasets, decades of missions, and a literature no human can read all of. Real space data goes in and a legendary project comes out. To be eligible, your project must be built with Cursor.

The more you use Cursor, the more likely you are to win. You must also use the Grok Imagine or Voice API in your project. Bonus points, if you use Grok Bot for project planning and team collaboration. Anyone who submits to our challenge will be entered to win a Cursor Owala water bottle.

Top 4 Receive Prizes

DROPBOX

Dropbox Challenge

Dropbox helps people find, organize, and get more from the content that powers their work. We're building a smarter, unified Dropbox experience where files and cloud content come together, and AI makes it effortless to find what you need, understand it, and turn it into action. Our goal is simple: spend less time searching and managing content, and more time doing meaningful work.

Your challenge: Turn digital chaos into something useful.

We all accumulate folders, photos, files, documents, notes, and other digital content faster than we can organize it. Build a creative solution that transforms messy, fragmented content into something organized, understandable, or actionable.

💡 Ideas to explore (but not limited to):

- Make photo libraries smarter. Build an intelligent photo organization experience that automatically turns a messy camera roll into meaningful collections. Use AI to recognize people and pets, identify events and locations, group related images, or surface forgotten moments, helping people spend less time organizing and more time rediscovering the memories that matter.

- Turn files into action. Instead of treating files as things we simply open and read, what if our content could actually do something? Build a project that turns documents, images, videos, notes, or other files into actions. An agent could turn a folder of travel documents into a trip plan, transform class materials into a personalized tutor, continuously summarize a collection of research, or pull decisions and next steps from project files.

- Reimagine how we organize digital content. Folders have been around for decades. What could replace, or reinvent, them? Build a new way to organize, discover, understand, or interact with digital content. Think spatial file systems, self-organizing content, relationship graphs, multiplayer knowledge spaces, or something we haven't imagined yet.

- Build a StudentOS. At Dropbox, we built CompanyOS: an internal tool that maps our organization by connecting people and teams with the goals and work they own. What would that look like for a university? Build a StudentOS that makes a complex campus easier to understand and navigate by connecting students, professors, classes, clubs, research labs, projects, events, and goals. Help someone discover who's working on what, how things are connected, and where they fit in, and use AI to make that information easier to explore, organize, and act on.

Prizes:

1st Place: AirPods Max 2 + fast-track interview process for an internship at Dropbox

2nd Place: JBL PartyBox Encore Essential 2 Speaker + fast-track interview process for an internship at Dropbox.

DEEPGRAM

Build Something Worth Talking To

Voice is how people ask questions, give directions, and get help when their hands are full. You can build something that listens and talks back in a weekend. Pick something you would actually use, like a study tool, a hotline for your club, a game you talk to, or even a to-do list - and add voice to it with Deepgram. You get \$200 in free credit, a starter repo that runs in minutes, and us on site all weekend to debug your audio with you. To qualify, your project must call a Deepgram API in your project (think transcribing speech to text, turning text into speech, or building a full end to end voice agent). Winners get 4 Nintendo Switches. To get started, you can grab a free key at console.deepgram.com/signup.

Prizes:

1st Place: 1 Nintendo Switch for each member of the winning team

ARROWSTREET CAPITAL

Best Textual Analysis Hack

Corporate text is everywhere and growing exponentially – news, marketing, reports, interview transcripts, filings, and other corporate disclosures. The volume, diversity, and vague nature of text can make it challenging to interpret precisely. Can AI techniques help counter the scale of this problem? Your challenge is to demonstrate how AI can be used to evaluate a company's use of greenwashing (overstating or giving false impressions about environmental benefits). Starting from publicly-available corporate text – a product label, policy or claim – classify the likelihood that the statements are a form of greenwashing. Your project will be judged based on the quality of evidence retrieved (with sources cited), the creativity and sophistication of textual analysis, and the conclusion confidence, as well as how you present the findings.

Prize: (1st Place Only) \$1,000 distributed among the team + interview with a member of our Research team for each member of the winning team + one hoodie for each member of the winning team

HACKSTER

Create What's Next Hackathon

We're challenging you to design and prototype a working hardware project – anything from a connected device to a full embedded system – using real dev boards from Nordic Semiconductor!

Whether you're chasing a smart-home concept, an IoT sensor network, a wearable, or

something nobody's thought of yet, this is your chance to turn that idea into something that actually powers on.

No theme restrictions, no box to check! You'll have around 24 hours (8–12 hours of real build time), so this is about creating a working prototype or MVP, not a finished product. Show us what you can figure out, not what's perfect.

You'll be building with one of three Nordic boards, and we'll help you pick the one that fits your idea (see "Which board should I pick?" below under resources). No soldering required or supported on-site – everything's designed to work straight out of the box using each board's onboard components and headers.

We are giving away thousands of dollars in prizes to the top 3 projects! These winners will win the “Best in Show” for a AMD Kria KR260 Robotics Starter Kit (\$349 value)

REGENERON
Make Clinical Trials and Biostatistics better!
Regeneron is a leading biotechnology company that invents, develops and commercializes life-transforming medicines for people with serious diseases. Regeneron is founded and led by physician-scientists.
Grand Prize & Honorable Mentions